

FUNCTIONAL ENGLISH WORKSHEET 01

Read the following passage and answer the given questions.

The New Year is the time for resolution. Mentally, at least most of us could compile formidable lists of 'do's and don'ts'. The same old favorites recur year in and year out with the children, do a thousand and one job about the house, be nice to people we don't like, drive carefully, and take the dog for a walk every day. Past experience has taught us that certain accomplishments are beyond attainment. If we remain deep rooted liars, it is only because we have so often experienced the frustration that results from failure.

Most of us fail in our efforts at self-improvement because our schemes are too ambitious and we never have time to carry them out. We also make the fundamental error of announcing our resolution to everybody so that we look even more foolish when we slip back into our bad old ways. Aware of these pitfalls, this year I attempted to keep my resolution to myself. I limited myself to two modest ambitions, to do physical exercise every morning and to read more in the evening. An overnight party on New Year's Eve provided me with a good excuse for not carrying out either of these new resolutions on the first day of the year, but on the second, I applied myself assiduously to the task.

The daily exercise lasted only eleven minutes and I proposed to do them early in the morning before anyone had got up. The self-discipline required to drag myself out of bed eleven minutes earlier than usual was considerable. Nevertheless, I managed to creep down into the living room for two days before anyone found me out. After jumping about in the carpet and twisted the human frame into uncomfortable positions. I sat down at the breakfast table in an exhausted condition. It was this that betrayed me. The next morning the whole family trooped into watch the performance. That was really unsettling but I fended off the taunts and jibes of the family good humoredly and soon everybody got used to the idea. However, my enthusiasm waned, the time I spent at exercises gradually diminished. Little by little the eleven minutes fell to zero. By January 10th I was back to where I had started from. I argued that if I spent less time exhausting myself at exercises in the morning. I would keep my mind fresh for reading when I got home from work. Resisting the hypnotizing effect of television, I sat in my room for a few evenings with my eyes glued to a book. One night, however, feeling cold and lonely, I went downstairs and sat in front of the television pretending to read. That proved to be my undoing, for I soon got back to the old bad habit of dozing off in front of the screen. I still haven't given up my resolution to do more reading. In fact, I have just bought a book entitled 'How to Read a Thousand Words a Minute'.

Perhaps it will solve my problem, but I just have not had time to read it.

Q1. Why most of us fail in our efforts of self-improvement?

Q2. Why is it a basic mistake to announce our resolutions to everybody?

Q3. Why did the writer not carry out his resolution on New Year's Day?

ANSWER-1

Most of us fail because our self-improvement plans are overly ambitious, and we never find the time to implement them. In addition, we have a tendency to go back into previous patterns.

ANSWER-2

Announcing our resolutions to everyone makes us look stupid when we eventually revert to old habits, causing embarrassment when we fail.

ANSWER-3

The writer went to an overnight party on New Year's Eve, which was a decent reason for not making resolutions on the first day of the year. He started on the second day.

WORKSHEET 02

Listen to the podcast till 10:05 minutes and answer the following questions.

<https://youtu.be/zYHn9aZPC8A?feature=shared>

Q1. What does Tess like to do? Where did she go to do what she likes?

Q2. Which personality Yasmin wants to meet? And, why?

Q3. Summarize the conversation of Rachel in your own words.

ANSWER-1

Tess enjoys cycling. She visited the Lake District, which is in northwest England.

ANSWER-2

Yasmin admires Shakira's singing prowess and songwriting ability, therefore she wants to meet her. "I find her voice very unique, and I would really like to collaborate with her on writing a song, sort of a duet that would be nothing but a great learning experience." Yasmin appreciates Shakira's cultural influences in her music and admires her as a person.

ANSWER-3

Rachel describes how, in 1998, she traveled to Buenos Aires, Argentina, to see the culture of the city, as expressed in its "mosaic of cultures." On her first night in the city, she noticed people tangoing. Tango, as a dance, shows the diverse backgrounds of the city's inhabitants. Its origins date back to the early twentieth century, when individuals from a variety of countries arrived in Buenos Aires. Rachel believed that tango was the only way to learn about Argentinean culture, so she paired with a Scottish teacher who taught her how to perform tango, which helped her develop an appreciation for dance and the city.